

INVESTOR BRIEF · DRAFT V1 · 2 OCT 2026

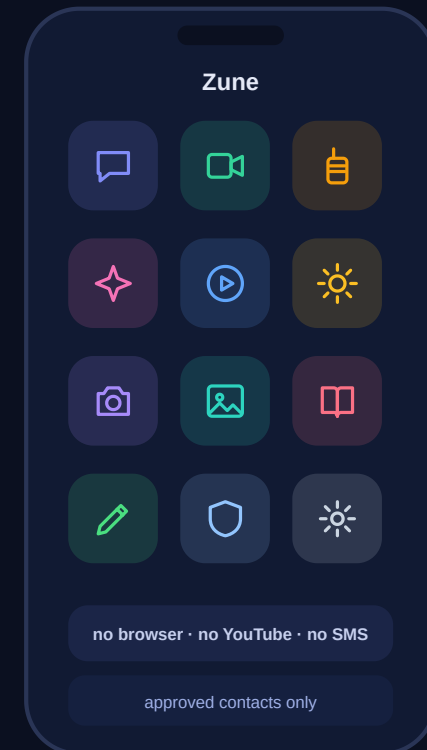
Zune

working name (codename; trademark clearance pending)

A kids-only Android.
No browser. No YouTube exit. No cellular calling.
Safe by construction, not by policy.

A custom Android 17 OS image and a browser-based parent portal, flashed onto qualified Pixel phones. Text, voice and video only with parent-approved contacts, a kid-safe AI tutor, curated learning videos, weather lessons and more.

India first English only ~200-user first phase Software-led, Pixel first Own hardware later



A phone where the unsafe things simply do not exist

What we are building, why it can win, what could kill it

What it is

A custom **Android 17 (AOSP)** OS image for children plus a **parent web portal**. The child's phone has **no web browser, no route to YouTube, no cellular calls or SMS**. It has WhatsApp-style 1:1 messaging, voice and video calls with parent-approved contacts, a kid-safe AI assistant (text + images), curated learning videos, weather with lessons, walkie-talkie, camera, photos, journal, notebook and a book reader.

Sold as **software plus a flash-and-hand-over service** on the customer's own qualified phone. **Version 1:** we flash and re-lock the phone and hand it back (about 200 users, India, Pixel 10a/9a). Later: customer self-install, then **our own hardware**.

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browsers and routes to YouTube
enforced in the OS image

Android 17

AOSP android-17.0.0_r1
released 2026-06-16

~200

users in the first phase
customer-owned Pixels, India

Pixel 10a/9a

first supported phones
re-locked with our own key

2 stages

S1: everything exists, S2:
better
no dates promised yet

21

research reports written
10 through a skeptic pass

The bet

Parents should not have to police a general-purpose phone. Remove the dangerous capabilities from the OS, and give parents a portal for everything that remains.

Why it can win

- **Enforcement in the image, not an app.** No browser and no YouTube route exist on the device; the bootloader is re-locked so only our signed images boot.
- **Contact graph, not phone numbers.** 1:1 text, voice, video and walkie-talkie only with contacts both families approve; no groups, no strangers.
- **One product, not ten apps.** AI tutor, curated learning videos, weather lessons, camera, journal, book reader, parent portal.
- **Software-led model.** No hardware inventory; recurring revenue from cloud services (portal, AI, comms, content).
- **Timing.** Android 17 ships a native supervision framework; child-safety law is tightening worldwide.

What could kill it

- **Google firmware licence** for commercially re-distributing Pixel firmware is unread and unresolved. **High**
- **Security patching.** AOSP source drops twice a year; public fixes reach downstream months late (~125-day median seen). **High**
- **Re-lock support.** Only Pixel has vendor-documented custom-key re-lock; Snapdragon phones are unproven. **High**
- **India child-privacy law (DPDP).** Under-18 is a child; a parental-monitoring product needs legal confirmation. **High**
- **Addressable base.** Qualified Pixels are scarce and costly in India (see Market). **Med**
- **YouTube API terms** for topic-driven curation inside a closed client. **Med**

Details, mitigations and evidence quality: Risk register and Evidence status pages.

Every kids' phone today is policy on top of an open phone

Where Zune sits, and why now

1. Screen-time and filter apps

Family Link, Qustodio, Net Nanny, Bark app

- ✓ Policy layer on an open phone
- ✗ Child can still reach a browser and YouTube
- ✗ Defeated by reset, safe mode, sideloading, other apps
- ✗ Parents police an adult-grade device

2. Managed kids' phones

Pinwheel, Bark Phone, Gabb, Troomi

- ✓ Rebadged commodity phones plus managed software
- ✗ Browser-free by policy, not by image (our reading; to validate)
- ✓ Subscription \$15-20/mo; devices \$100-240 (secondary sources)
- ✗ Pinwheel does not install on your own phone

3. Zune

Capabilities are absent from the OS image

- ✓ No browser or YouTube exit in the image; re-locked bootloader
- ✓ Contact graph both families approve; no strangers, no groups
- ✓ Parent portal in any browser; signed policy; offline-safe
- ✓ Software-led: customer brings the phone

WHERE ENFORCEMENT LIVES

Layer	Filter apps	Managed kids' phones*	Zune
App (filters, screen time)	enforces here	enforces here	enforces here
Device policy (MDM / supervision)	policy only	enforces here	enforces here
OS image (what exists on the phone)	stock / not ours	stock / not ours	enforces here
Bootloader (what can boot)	stock / not ours	stock / not ours	enforces here
Updates (who ships fixes)	stock / not ours	stock / not ours	enforces here

*Our reading of how managed kids' phones work (stock firmware plus managed-device software; R02 F9, inferred). To validate.

WHY NOW

- **Android 17** adds a native supervision framework (SupervisionManager, ROLE_SUPERVISION) we can anchor on. R01 F6
- **AI tutors** are now credible for children when wrapped in age policy, moderation and parent visibility. R07
- **Regulation** is moving toward duty of care for minors (India DPDP; US and EU rules). R11, R19
- **AOSP is open** and Pixel offers a documented route to custom images re-locked with our own key. R02

Competitor facts come from secondary sources (R02 F9); the Market page validates and extends them.

One safe phone for a child, one portal for the parent

Stage 1 scope: everything exists in its simplest form (D1-D21)

 Messenger 1:1 text + emoji; approved contacts; no groups, no links	 Voice & video calls 1:1 over the internet; approved contacts only	 Walkie-talkie Push-to-talk with approved contacts
 AI assistant Chat UI; text + image input; age policy; parent-visible	 Learning videos Curated YouTube embeds, only inside Zune	 Weather Live forecast with 'why is it...?' lessons
 Camera Kid camera; no geotags	 Photos Private by default; parent-shared	 Book reader EPUB; parent-approved library
 Journal & notebook Private text, drawing, handwriting	 Settings (minimal) Wi-Fi and mobile data as standard; nothing else needed	 Never on device Browser, YouTube, app store, cellular calls, SMS

Parent portal (any browser)

- Approve contacts (both families for cross-family)
- Read messages and AI chats; review calls metadata
- Set screen-time and quiet hours
- Control AI and learning-video settings
- Pair and manage devices (QR claim code)
- Remote lock; activity feed; approvals queue
- *Later:* parent-side voice and video calling

PRINCIPLES

- English only; India first
- Parent-visible by design (age-appropriate disclosure to the child)
- Safe when the network is down (signed, cached policy)
- Nothing the child does can add an app or open the web

SAFETY DEFAULTS

- Every contact needs parent approval; cross-family contacts need both families
- No groups, links, attachments or discovery in messaging (Stage 1)
- No recording or covert listening on calls or walkie-talkie
- Stage 1 locations: parent-set places only

STAGE 2: MAKE IT BETTER

- Richer content, games, sensors, climate stories
- Parent-side voice and video calling
- Customer self-install and more qualified devices
- More languages (Hindi and regional)

How it fits together

Phone, cloud and factory: three planes with one signed trust chain

ON THE CHILD'S PHONE



CLOUD

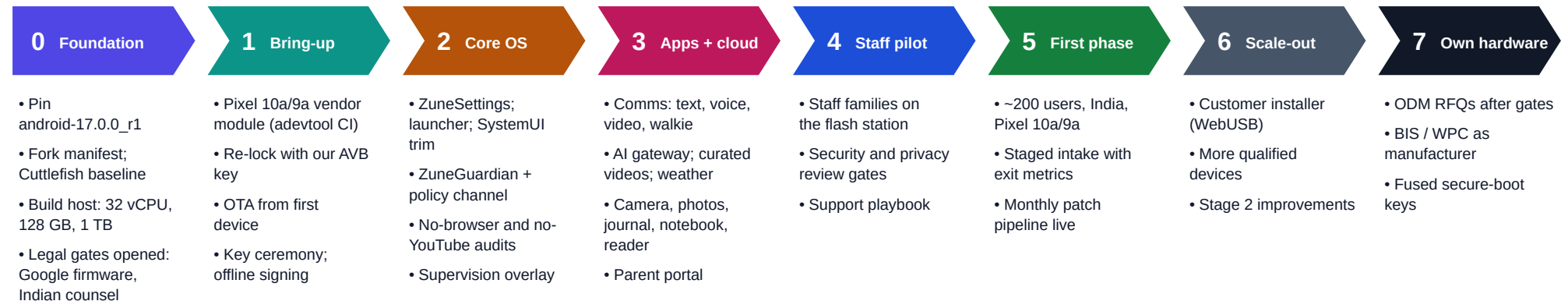


Source: reports R01, R03, R05, R09, R10, R13, R16, R18. Technology choices are recommendations, not yet built.

Confidential. Figures are labelled sourced / reported / estimate; see Evidence status.

Roadmap: gates before dates

Sequenced by dependency; durations come after staffing and funding decisions



STAGE 1: make every feature exist, end to end, in its simplest form

STAGE 2: make it better

GATES

- **G0 Legal:** written answer or counsel opinion on Google firmware; Indian counsel on DPDP and OTT rules; no paid launch before it.
- **G1 Device:** re-lock verified on a sacrificial unit of every qualified model; OEM terms signed.
- **G2 Security:** monthly patch pipeline, key custody (offline HSM), OTA tested on real devices.
- **G3 Pilot exit:** install success, support load, child-safety incidents and bypass attempts within thresholds.

EXTERNAL DEPENDENCIES

- **Google:** Pixel firmware licence; partner security-patch access (unknown for a startup)
- **Indian counsel:** DPDP consent architecture; OTT messaging; handset rules
- **LLM vendor:** terms for products used by children; India availability
- **YouTube:** API compliance review for a closed, curated client
- **Hosting:** India-region cloud; LiveKit (self-host or cloud)

No calendar dates are stated because no staffing or funding assumptions exist yet. Phases derive from reports R01, R02, R15, R16, R17, R18, R21.

Confidential. Figures are labelled sourced / reported / estimate; see Evidence status.

Decision log

Dated founder decisions; later decisions supersede earlier ones. Canonical source: docs/REQUIREMENTS.md

#	Decision	Date
D1	No web browser on the device.	2026-10-02
D2	No way for the end user to reach YouTube (no app, site, link-out, or deep link). Videos appear only inside the Zune Videos section.	2026-10-02
D3	Videos are curated YouTube content, shown only if relevant to the child's age group or to a topic the child asked about (research). Fully controlled experience.	2026-10-02
D4	SUPERSEDED by D19 (2026-10-02). (was: Cellular voice calls and SMS are IN scope.)	2026-10-02
D5	SUPERSEDED by D19 (2026-10-02). (was: Parent controls an allowlist of numbers that can call the device (inbound) and which numbers the child can call/communicate with (outbound).)	2026-10-02
D6	SUPERSEDED by D19 (2026-10-02). (was: SMS is not readable on the device ; it is readable in the parental-control interface.)	2026-10-02
D7	WhatsApp-like in-product messenger between kids using Zune devices. 1:1 only (no groups). Text + emoji only. Under the parental contact controls (approved contacts only). (Was "same as calls/SMS"; see D19.)	2026-10-02
D8	Video calling only with approved participants: other Zune kids, or parents via the parental-control interface. The parent-side calling interface is deferred ("later").	2026-10-02
D9	Weather app that also teaches children about weather.	2026-10-02
D10	Walkie-talkie (push-to-talk).	2026-10-02
D11	AI assistant with a ChatGPT-style conversation UI; kids can ask questions and send images .	2026-10-02

Decision log (continued)

Dated founder decisions; later decisions supersede earlier ones. Canonical source: docs/REQUIREMENTS.md

#	Decision	Date
D12	Parental controls are browser-based (parent portal).	2026-10-02
D13	The product is limited to a small, curated set of supported devices. High-end Snapdragon-class devices are acceptable ("very high grade"); the device list is not limited to Pixels. Supersedes the Pixel-first recommendation in `docs/research/02-hardware-target.md` until topic 15 reports.	2026-10-02
D14	The device has a Settings app with the minimum settings: Wi-Fi and mobile data stay fully standard ("as it is"), plus only what is fairly required. Nothing unnecessary.	2026-10-02
D15	Business model: sell the OS image (software); customers bring a qualified phone from a curated supported-device list and install it themselves. We do not sell or inventory hardware.	2026-10-02
D16	Version 1 delivery is company-provisioned. The first batch of users contact us; we flash the image on their qualified phone and give it to them. Customer self-install (the BYO installer of D15) comes in a later version. (Phones are assumed to be customer-supplied, consistent with D15; correct this if we will supply phones.)	2026-10-02
D17	Start on a Pixel. The founder accepted beginning with a Pixel (Pixel 10a / 9a class, "a good performing phone") as the first supported device. A Snapdragon phone is not required for v1 ; Snapdragon candidates (Fairphone Gen 6+, Nothing Phone (3)) become a later second-source / premium tier, subject to relock bring-up and written OEM terms (report 15). Supersedes D13's Snapdragon preference for v1.	2026-10-02
D18	India is the first launch market. Supersedes assumption A1 (US). Implications to research: India's child-privacy law (DPDP Act and Rules; a "child" is under 18), telecom/messaging rules (DoT, TRAI), Indian carriers and VoLTE, emergency numbers and cell-broadcast alerts, Indic languages, rupee pricing and recurring-payment rules, Pixel supply and warranty in India.	2026-10-02
D19	No cellular voice calls and no SMS. All communication is internet-based and WhatsApp-style: in-product text messages, voice calls and video calls , 1:1 only (no groups), approved contacts only, parent-controlled. Supersedes D4, D5 and D6. The device needs only data connectivity (Wi-Fi and mobile data, D14).	2026-10-02
D20	English only for version 1: no Hindi or other Indian languages (Stage 2 at the earliest).	2026-10-02
D21	First phase: about 200 users on Pixel phones; eventually the company builds its own hardware. Own hardware is a later roadmap phase, not v1. The 10/25/100 cohort sizes in report 18 are replaced by a staged ~200-user first phase.	2026-10-02

Glossary

Terms an Android and infrastructure reader will want pinned down

Term	Meaning
AOSP	Android Open Source Project: Google's open base of Android
AVB	Android Verified Boot; a custom key lets the bootloader trust only our images
Re-lock	Locking the bootloader again after flashing, so nothing else can be installed
A/B + OTA	Dual-slot system with over-the-air updates and rollback
adevtool	GrapheneOS tool that builds Pixel vendor modules from Google's stock images
Cuttlefish	Google's virtual Android device, used for hardware-free testing
SPL	Security patch level, e.g. 2026-06-05
GKI	Generic Kernel Image: Google's common Android kernel
Mainline / APEX	Updatable system modules; with no Google Play they update only through our OTA

WebView	System web renderer that apps embed; a browsing risk we must contain
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Term	Meaning
Supervision framework	Android 17 SupervisorManager / ROLE_SUPERVISION for parental controls
FGS	Foreground service: Android's rule for background audio, camera and mic
LiveKit / SFU	Open-source real-time media server for voice, video and push-to-talk
DSC	Device Support Contract: our checklist a phone must pass to be qualified
DPDP Act	India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (child = under 18)
COPPA	US children's privacy law (under 13)
BIS / WPC	Indian product-registration and radio-approval regimes
IMD	India Meteorological Department
WEA	US Wireless Emergency Alerts; India uses cell-broadcast alerts

GMS	Google Mobile Services (Play, FCM...): not used in Zune
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